

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	ENGL1A30
Subject Title	Strategic Data Communication for the Professional Workplace
Credit Value	3
Level	1
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Exclusion: ENGL1A27 [Remarks: ENGL students may take this subject.]
Objectives	Data literacy is the most critical currency for leaders in the modern digital economy. Beyond basic numbers, the ability to transform complex analytics into compelling narratives gives future professionals a clear competitive edge. With this in mind, this subject aims to: 1. Empower students with the confidence to communicate different aspects and types of data analytics in fluent English; 2. Teach students to master the art of data storytelling by adopting practical strategies to avoid common pitfalls in professional communication; and 3. Familiarise students with the communication standards in different industries and professional contexts.
Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Master the strategic use of language to turn raw data into persuasive professional intelligence; b. Communicate the trajectory of data analytics – from descriptive to prescriptive - in fluent written and spoken English; c. Execute communication strategies that influence stakeholders and achieve professional objectives; d. Adapt information to meet the specific needs and high expectations of diverse global industries; and e. Fulfil the CAR reading and writing requirements in English.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	• “The Art of the Audience” ○ How communication needs and expectations vary across industries.

	○ Understanding data variety: introduction to different data types (e.g., quantitative vs. qualitative and structured vs. unstructured) ○ The relevance of data analytics across industries ○ The four phases of data analytics • The Science of Influence: Strategies and pitfalls ○ Knowledge vs. value vs. policy claims: Moving from information to action. ○ The rhetorical triangle – Using logic (<i>Logos</i>), credibility (<i>Ethos</i>), and emotional resonance (<i>Pathos</i>) to sell data ○ Metaphors and analogies • Communicating the background: Descriptive analytics ○ Data distribution: Communicating the "Big Picture" with clarity ○ Trends and changes: Identifying and explaining patterns of success • Communicating processes and outcomes: Diagnostic and predictive analytics ○ Relationships, causes, and effects: Decoding the "why" behind the data ○ Forecasts: Communicating risk and opportunity with professional authority • Communicating actions and implications: Prescriptive analytics ○ Persuading people in power ○ Advocating change: Turning data into professional impact.
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Adopting a highly practical and learner-centred approach, this subject follows a blended learning model designed for real-world application and flexibility. A variety of engaging in-class and out-of-class activities will be implemented, requiring students to actively manage their progress and improve their self-regulation skills in a professional context. Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools will be integrated into the learning process to assist students in analysing data patterns and refining their communicative delivery. To bridge the gap between theory and practice, students will utilise diverse online platforms and digital tools to practice communicating with data in real-time scenarios. This combination of AI-enhanced learning, platform-based practice, and independent research empowers students to master the digital fluencies and self-management required in the modern workplace.

**Assessment Methods
in Alignment with
Intended Learning
Outcomes**

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				
		a	b	c	d	e
1. Dashboard Submission & Exhibition	20%	✓		✓	✓	
2. Oral Presentation	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3. Written Report	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
4. Class Participation	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Total	100%					

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

Dashboard Submission & Exhibition (20%)

In this initial phase, student groups will select a real-life dataset from a professional field (e.g., finance, health, or marketing) and design a dashboard. To simulate a professional creative environment, these dashboards will be digitally or physically exhibited in class during a "gallery session." This allows students to showcase their visual literacy skills and receive immediate peer and teacher feedback, which they can then use to refine their analysis for the subsequent oral presentation.

Oral Presentation (30%)

As a direct continuation of the project, groups will deliver a 20-minute presentation using their previously developed dashboards. Moving beyond simple facts, students will explain "why" the data is changing and predict future trends. This "Data Story" requires students to use persuasive techniques (Logos, Pathos, Ethos) to influence an audience and provide actionable professional insights based on the feedback received during the exhibition.

Written Report (40%)

The written report is the formal conclusion of the project. Students transform their oral presentation into a professional recommendation paper. This report requires a deep dive into the

	data to advocate for a specific change or policy. To fulfil the ER (Reading) and EW (Writing) requirements, students must integrate course readings and external research to provide an evidence-based justification for their proposed solutions. Class Participation (10%) This component rewards students for their active contribution to the blended learning environment. It measures engagement in both in-class discussions and out-of-class activities. Fulfilling the ER & EW requirements: ER: Students will need to read the recommended texts before they are able to complete Assessment 2 & 3. The total number of pages of these four sources is more than 200. EW: Please refer to Assessment 2 and 3 above. Students must obtain a D or above on the oral presentation and written assignment to pass the course.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	26 Hrs.
	▪ Seminars	13 Hrs.
	▪ Other student study effort:	
	Independent online learning	22 Hrs.
	▪ Independent research	22 Hrs.
	▪ Assignments	22 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	105 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Required readings (243 pages): Allchin, C. (2021). <i>Communicating with data: Making your case with data</i> (1st ed.). O'Reilly. (Extracts from chapters 1-10, 75 pages) Dykes, B. (2019). <i>Effective Data Storytelling: How to Drive Change with Data, Narrative and Visuals</i>. Wiley. (Chapter 2, 21 pages) Perkins, P. S., & Brown, L. (2008). <i>The art and science of communication: Tools for effective communication in the workplace</i>. John Wiley & Sons, Incorporated. (Extracts from chapters 1-5, 7. 75 pages)	

	Shirley, K. (2009). <i>Contemporary business report writing</i> (4th ed.). Cengage Learning. (Chapter 4 (33 pages) - Chapter 11 (16 pages) – Chapter 12 (23 pages)) Further readings: Adler, N. J., & Gundersen, A. (2007). <i>International Dimensions of Organizational Behavior</i> (5th ed.). Cengage Learning. Cairo, A. (2016). <i>The Truthful Art: Data, Charts, and Maps for Communication</i>. New Riders. Evans, S. (2010). Business as usual: the use of English in the professional world in Hong Kong. <i>English for Specific Purposes</i> 29(3), 153-167. Gass, R. H., & Seiter, J. S. (2026). <i>Persuasion: Social Influence and Compliance Gaining</i> (8th ed.). Routledge. Hullman, J., & Diakopoulos, N. (2011). Visualization rhetoric: Framing effects in narrative visualization. <i>IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics</i>, 17(12), 2431-2440. Nussbaumer Knaflic, C. (2015). <i>Storytelling with Data: A Data Visualization Guide for Business Professionals</i>. Wiley. O’Keefe, D. J. (2003). Message properties, mediating states, and theoretical explanation: Confidence, content, and compliance in persuasive message effects. <i>Communication Theory</i>, 13(3), 251-274. Pandey, A. V., et al. (2014). The persuasive power of data visualization. <i>IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics</i>, 20(12), 2211-2220. Selected data sources and learning resources Datacamp (www.datacamp.com) Kaggle datasets (www.kaggle.com) Statista (www.statista.com) TED talks (www.ted.com) The Economist Intelligence Unit (www.eiu.com) Udemy (www.udemy.com)
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Revised by Azar Tajabadi, May 2026